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SPORTS BUSINESS TV-RADIO SHIPPING

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Jackie Jensen Fights for Life

AS SULLY SEES IT

By Prescott Sullivan



Speaking of Similes

It was about to be consigned to the wastebasket along with the usual pile of junk mail when we happened to notice the lettering on the envelope.

Publicity releases from the University of Texas at El Paso are different from the others. To be sure, they get thrown away more often than not, but we like to read 'em first.

Eddie Mullens, a tall, cigar-chewing Texan, who is the director of the UTEP news bureau, has a flair for similes. More than a flair. What he has is a flair for an affliction. This is a guy who can't put two sentences together without working a simile into 'em. At least one.

Some are pretty good. Some are so-so. And some are just plain awful. You take 'em as you find 'em and, for better or worse, they're always there.

In this week's release, Mullens deals with a track meet between his school and the University of California, tomorrow night, in El Paso.

From it we learn, metaphorically, that Wayne Vandenburg, the UTEP track coach, has been on the road so much recently he has dislaid hands from washing his perma-press shirts.

Also, that he is harder to please than a beaver in a cement factory, burdened with more problems than a boxer with sticky shoes, and lower than a cotton picker's salary because several of his key men are ailing.

His concern is the greater, moreover, on account of the California Bears are coming on stronger than the security guard around the White House.

In the sprits they are tougher than a steel toothpick. Their dashmen give them the best one-two punch since Joe Louis. And shotputter Bob Hargreaves is rougher than a lumberjack's beard.

UTEP's indoor season was nothing to brag about. Coach Vandenburg was as disappointed as a fisherman with a bucket of dead worms. In a number of events the team was weaker than a mud fence on a rainy day.

On the brighter side, two distance runners have since recovered from injuries. Both are as ready as a couple of cannibals at a missionaries' convention.

That will help.

But will it help enough? Much will depend on John Birkelbach, a weighman. He has the potential, but in his last start he finished out the money and that left him as frustrated as a lame cat stalking a canary.

Anyway, coach Vandenburg, described by Mullens as the fastest mouth in the West, hasn't given up. If his team outscues Cal, he'll be happier than a hippie in a used clothing store. Happier, no doubt, than he is likely to be with the simile.

As we say, Mullens gets off some real stinkers. It isn't his fault. The poor guy has this thing and he has to live with it.

Everybody on the UTEP athletic staff is affected by his plight. In the spring sports guide, baseball coach Andy Cohen, an ex-Giant, is represented as being as nervous as an alligator in a purse factory over the team's hitting.

On the other hand, the pitching appears to be as sturdy as a new pump handle. Cohen, an old pro who has been around longer than the buffalo nickel, is counting on his pitchers to be as hard to solve as a Chinese chain-letter.

Cohen works at his job. He stays busier than an Adam's apple at a yodeling match and he knows more about baseball than a flea does about a fat dog's back.

Another popular member of the staff is Assistant Athletic Director Jim Bowden, as welcome on the campus as a footbath is to a mailman.

And then there's Ross Moore, the trainer, who paved the way for Track Coach Vandenburg and had things moving like a bubble dancer in a room full of slingshots when the latter arrived. Moore has more energy than a vitamin commercial. He can tape up a sore ankle quicker than a monkey can skin a banana.

Not to be ignored, of course, is the top man, athletic director George McCarthy. He's had his headaches. There was a time when things looked darker than a burned warehouse.

No more. McCarthy proved tougher than scrub oak in a whittling contest. Thanks to his drive, his get up and go, UTEP's athletic program today is as solid as Fort Knox.

Remember, Mullens said it. We didn't. All we can be blamed for is keeping it out of the wastebasket. Sorry.

RENO (Special) — Doctors predicted today that the next 96 hours would be critical in Jackie Jensen's battle to survive a severe heart attack.

Besides his baseball job, he served as Nevada chairman of the March of Dimes charity drive, presided over the Sierra Nevada Sportswriters and Broadcasters Association and was active in other community work.

His second wife, the former Kathy Cortesi, said Jensen complained at breakfast yesterday morning of chest pains, but insisted on driving from their home at Verdi, Nev., eight miles west of Reno, to the college campus.

There, while directing baseball practice, he collapsed. Players rushed him to the Washoe Medical Center, where attendants placed him in the cardiac intensive care section at 3:40 p.m.

"If he survives the next four days," a doctor was quoted as saying, "his chances are good. But he will face from six to eight weeks in bed."

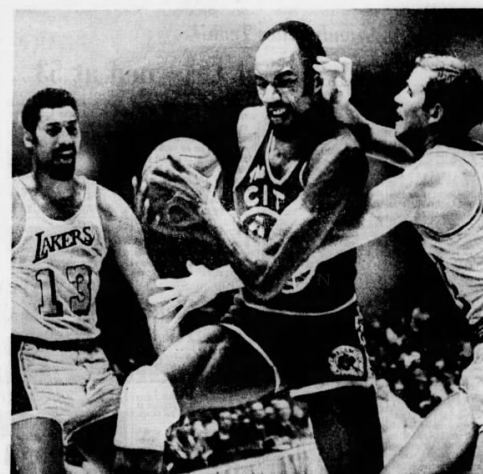
Jensen was born in San Francisco March 9, 1927. Primarily a football player as a youngster, he earned All-

America fullback honors as a member of Lynn "Pappy" Waldorf's great University of California team that played in the 1941 Rose Bowl.

A knee injury prompted him to pass up his senior year and sign a professional baseball contract with the Oakland A's of the old

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Warriors Dupe L.A., Lead by 1



"NO YOU DON'T," WARRIOR NATE THURMOND (C) TELLS LAKER KEITH ERICKSON With Chamberlain (13) is the observer during S.F.'s 99-94 playoff win

'Set Pattern' Scheme Brings 99-94 Victory

By Bucky Walter

LOS ANGELES — One thing's sure, the L.A. Lakers won't disdainfully sweep the Warriors under the rug in four straight playoff games as they did last year.

The W's, trailing by six points with four minutes to play, exploded for the next 11 points and left the Forum last night with a 99-94 victory in the series opener.

Jeff Mullins ripped through 26 points, Rudy La Russa rammed in 32 and the Warriors as a team shook off early Lakers "rightness" to send 10,697 customers home grogging.

Barth Van Breda Kolff, the Lakers' coach, growled even more.

"After 82 games, we lost all semblance of team play," moaned Dutch. "But we beat 'em four straight last season, so who's to say we won't win the next four?"

The Lakers hope to revitalize here tomorrow night in the second game of the series.

But they'll have to contend with a team that appears—off last night's

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Bar Owner Will Beg Wills' Pardon in Snub

WEST PALM BEACH (Fla.) — (AP) — The owner of a bar where Negro ballplayer Maury Wills was asked to leave says he will apologize for the incident, to the Montreal Expos shortly.

Pete Everett, owner of the Cock 'N' Bull bar, said, "I have been receiving about what happened, so I've contacted Mr. Fanning and he and Maury have agreed to meet and talk with me."

Wills, once the National League's Most Valuable Player, said he had been asked to leave two West Palm Beach bars Friday night because they said they didn't serve Negroes.



MAURY WILLS Apology requested

He said the bars were the Cock 'N' Bull and Miller's

Bar, and added that it was "the first time my big league career I have been discriminated against."

Everett declined further comment. However, Frank Mario, who said he was manager of the bar, earlier stated that the Cock 'N' Bull had a policy of not serving Negroes because white youths patronized the business and fights could break out.

Elmer Petko, owner of Miller's Bar, was unavailable for comment. Wills said he was asked to leave Miller's while shooting a game of pool with two newsmen. The trio then went to the Cock 'N' Bull where Wills said:

"I heard those same words again. 'We don't serve colored people.'"

Top Golfers In \$37,000 Match Here

By Nelson Cullenward

The famed Olympic Club Lake course, scene of two thrilling playoff matches in the 1955 and 1956 National Opens, will be the site of another great golf match in June.

This will be the final match in the Wonderful World of Golf television series and the two contestants will be battling for a \$37,000 prize in the 18-hole match on Tuesday, June 3.

Both the Shell Company and the Olympic Club want the largest number of golf fans possible to see this event, so it will be free to the public," says John Hallett, general manager of the OC.

Six prior matches are being played in great parts of the world and the two survivors will be seen this spring.

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Why Marichal Walked In Run

By Al Corona

PHOENIX — As far as Giants manager Clyde King is concerned, nothing beats winning, be it in spring training or league play.

But, even King will agree it's permissible to experiment in the spring. In fact, he expects his players to try something new or work extra on something old in pre-season competition.

A classic illustration was yesterday's 7-5 victory by the Giants over the new American League entry, Seattle, at Tempe.

Ace right-hander Juan Marichal, the \$100,000 Dominican Danny, recorded the winning seven innings and allowing only five hits.

But, in the process, Juan did something no one can recall he ever did before. He walked in a run with the bases full.

That made the score 7-2 and two more runs came in when Bobby Bonds dropped Tommy Davis' short pop to enter for a two-base error. But Juan managed to weather the storm.

"You can bet that never

would have happened in league play," King told reporters after the game.

"Juan told me he was experimenting with his curve when he walked Mike Hegan on '2 count."

"It's something a pitcher must do under game conditions and what better time can one find to do it than in the spring?"

King then asked that Mike McCormick had been doing a little experimenting of his own in his last pitching turn.

"Mike told me he was concentrating on his screwball,

throwing it on nearly every pitch."

This, of course, pleased King. It's no secret that Mike's inability to throw his newly found screwball effectively last year was one of the main reasons he fell from a 22-16 record in '67 to 12-14 in '68. If he is able to regain that lost touch it will make King's task that much easier.

By Zimmerman, a Seattle newspaperman, told us that the Giants were far the best club he's seen this spring.

They have the speed,

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